Case Study: Financial Dashboard Creation

Objective

To design an interactive Power BI dashboard that enables leadership to monitor monthly financial health, track key KPIs, analyse sales performance, evaluate budget adherence, and assess cashflow and receivables risk.

Key KPIs

- Total Revenue – Overall monthly revenue performance
- Gross Margin % - Gross Profit / Revenue
- EBITDA % - EBITDA/Revenue
- Net Cash- Cash Inflows – Cash Outflows

Tools Used

- Power BI Desktop
- Power Query
- DAX

Data Source

Sample financial dataset containing revenue, cost, cash flow, budget, region, and product-level information.

Data & Modelling Logic

A single financial fact table was used, containing revenue, costs, cash flow, aging, bucket, region, product/service, and month

Data Preparation performed in Power Query:

- Removed Blank rows
- Standardized month/date formats
- Corrected data types for numeric and text files
- Replaced missing financial values with zero
- Created receivables aging buckets
- Validated totals against source data

Core DAX Measures:

- Total Revenue = Sum of Revenue
- Gross Margin % = Gross Profit / Revenue
- EBITDA % = EBITDA / Revenue
- Net Cash = Cash Inflows – Cash Outflows
- Budget Variance % = (Actual Revenue – Budget)/ Budget

Dashboard Components

KPI Cards

Revenue, Gross Margin %, EBITDA %, Net Cash

Visuals

- Revenue & Gross Profit Trend (monthly line chart)
- Budget vs Actual with Variance % (combo chart)
- Product / Service Performance (bar chart)
- Receivables Aging (stacked bar)
- Cash Flow Waterfall (monthly net cash movement)

Interactivity

- Slicers for Month / Quarter / Year, Region, and Product / Service
- Drill down from Month to Product for detailed analysis

Key Insights

- Revenue shows consistent monthly growth, driven primarily by top- performing products
- Gross Margin remains stable, indicating controlled cost of goods.
- EBITDA margin fluctuates in higher operating expense months.
- Budget variance highlights overspending in selected periods.
- Receivables aging is concentrated in the 0 – 30-day bucket, indicating generally healthy collections.
- Net cash remains positive overall, with some months showing reduced liquidity.

Assumptions

- Missing financial values are set to zero
- Monthly aggregation was used for reporting
- Budget figures were aligned by month
- Receivables aging buckets were calculated using the provided aging days

Business Value

This dashboard provides leadership with a single source of truth to:

- Monitor profitability and operational efficiency
- Track budget performance
- Identify top products and regions
- Assess receivable risk
- Understand monthly cash movement

Supporting faster, data – driven financial decisions